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SUPERSEDING
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MILITARY SPECIFICATION

COMPRESS AND BANDAGE, GENERAL PURPOSE

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers a compress (with bandages) for use in the treatment of burns involving large areas of the body, and in the treatment of injuries of multiple types.

1.2 Classification. Compress and bandage shall be of one type, the compress being of the following sizes, as specified (see 6.1):

Size 1 - 18 by 22 inches
Size 2 - 22 by 36 inches

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

SPECIFICATIONS

Federal

L-C-166	Cellulose, Absorbent, Surgical.
V-T-276	Thread, Cotton.
FF-P-416	Pins; Safety.
CCC-G-101	Gauze, Absorbent.
MMM-A-250	Adhesive, Water-resistant, (For Sealing Fiberboard boxes).
PPP-B-636	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-T-45	Tape, Gummed, Paper, Reinforced.

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STANDARDS

Federal

FED-TEST-METHOD STD NO. 191	Textile Test Methods.
FED-STD-751	Stitches; Seams; and Stitching.

Military

MIL-STD-105	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129	Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of specifications and standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publication. The following document forms a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

U.S. PHARMACOPEIAL CONVENTION, INC.
Pharmacopeia of the United States

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Mack Publishing Company, Easton, PA)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. Raw material tests required in paragraphs 3.1.2, 3.1.3, 3.1.4 and 3.1.6 shall be done after the materials have been conditioned for at least 4 hours in a standard atmosphere of 65 percent, plus or minus 2 percent, relative humidity, at 70° Fahrenheit, plus or minus 2° Fahrenheit. The weight requirement of the absorbent filler, absorbent cellulose, and water repellent cellulose shall be determined after conditioning as above. The weight requirement of the complete compress shall also be determined after conditioning.

3.1.1 Gauze. Gauze used in the bandages and in the fabrication of the compress shall conform to Specification CCC-G-101 for the types as hereinafter specified.

3.1.2 Absorbent filler. Absorbent filler shall be bleached picker laps made from new or reworked cotton, full bleached cotton waste, picker drops, card strips, or other suitable fully bleached cotton waste and cellulose pulp. If cellulose pulp is used, it shall be made from bleached chemical wood pulp and not more than 25 percent by weight of the filler shall be composed of pulp. In the event that cellulose pulp is used in the absorbent filler, not

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more than 25 percent by weight of the absorbent filler shall be linters or extremely short fibered cotton. When tested as specified in 4.4.2, the filler shall have the following characteristics:

Absorbency. Filler test sample shall be completely submerged within 20 seconds and shall absorb not less than 16 times its weight of water.

pH. Filler shall have a pH of not less than 4.5 nor more than 9.5.

Dyes. Filler shall be free of dyes.

Soluble solids. Total water soluble solids in the filler shall be not greater than 1.5 percent and inorganic soluble solids shall be not greater than 0.4 percent.

Ash. Ash content shall be not greater than 1.5 percent.

Starch and dextrin. Starch and dextrin content shall not exceed limits as specified in test procedures.

3.1.3 Absorbent cellulose. The plies of creped absorbent cellulose shall be in conformance with Specification L-C-166, except that basis weight (480 sheets, 24 by 36) shall be 13 pounds, plus or minus 10 percent, and that absorbency requirements shall not apply. Absorbency after sterilization shall be such that test specimens shall be completely submerged within 30 seconds and shall absorb at least 16 times their weight of water when tested as specified in 4.4.3.

3.1.4 Water-repellent cellulose. Water-repellent cellulose shall be surgical cellulose made from bleached chemical wood pulp; shall be relatively free from impurities such as oil, pitch, slime, specks, and foreign matter, and shall be treated with a nontoxic, nonbleeding substance which will render the cellulose water-repellent, but not impervious to water vapor. Water repellency shall be such as to pass the test specified in 4.4.4. A suitable nontoxic, nonbleeding, coloring agent may be used in the water-repellent cellulose for identification purposes.

3.1.5 Polyethylene. Polyethylene shall be free of color, 1/2 mil minimum thick, made of virgin polyethylene.

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3.1.6 Nonwoven fabric backing. Backing material for the compress shall be nonwoven material fabricated of all cotton, all rayon, a mixture of cotton and rayon, or cotton, rayon and cellulose wadding. Regardless of composition, all nonwoven materials shall contain a plastic binder. If combined with cellulose wadding, the wadding shall be firmly adherent to, and an integral part of the nonwoven fabric, and not more than 25 percent by weight of this nonwoven fabric shall be composed of cellulose wadding. If the nonwoven material is composed of only cotton or rayon, or is a mixture of cotton and rayon, it shall have a minimum average weight of 1.55 ounces per square yard. If the nonwoven fabric is composed of cotton, rayon, and cellulose wadding, it shall have a minimum average weight of 1.75 ounces per square yard. The nonwoven fabric backing material (of any of the above mentioned compositions) shall have an average breaking strength of not less than 7 pounds per inch of width in the machine direction, and not less than 1.5 pounds per inch of width in the cross direction. The ultimate elongation of the fabric shall be not less than 5 percent. Breaking strength and ultimate elongation shall be tested as specified in 4.4.5.2. The fabric shall be treated with a nontoxic, nonbleeding substance which wil render it water-repellent, but not impervious to water vapor. Water-repellency shall be such that when tested as specified in 4.4.5.1, the spray rating shall be not less than 70.

3.1.7 Thread. Thread shall conform to type IA2, 3 -ply, ticket No. 60, as shown in table I of Specification V-T-276.

3.1.8 Safety pins. The safety pins shall be in conformance with size 3 of Specification FF-P-416.

3.1.9 Toxicity. In the finished compress and bandage, all components shall be nontoxic and nonirritating to the skin.

3.2 Unit of issue. The dressing unit shall consist of a compress, two bandages, and six safety pins.

3.3 Construction.

3.3.1 Compress. Both the size 1 and 2 compresses shall have identical construction, except for dimensions and weights, as hereinafter specified. A compress shall consist of layers of material, specified above, in the following sequence:

Gauze (type I, 1-ply).
Absorbent filler (in one layer).
Absorbent cellulose (14 to 16 plies).
Water-repellent cellulose (2 to 6 plies).
or
Polyethylene
Non-woven fabric (1-ply)

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In placement of the nonwoven fabric on the back of the compress, the material need not be placed so that the direction of the fabric with higher breaking strength corresponds with the long dimensions of the compress. The edges of the gauze facing shall be secured to the edges of the nonwoven fabric backing by sewing with a type 301 or 401 stitch in conformance with FED-STD-751, using approximately seven stitches per inch. Securing of these edges shall be so accomplished that all sides of the finished compress shall be closed and free of raw edges. To secure the contents of the compress against shifting, there shall be a diagonal line of stitching at each corner of the assembled size 1 and 2 compresses (stitching starting and ending approximately 3-1/2 inches from each corner), and at the approximate midpoint of each long edge of the size 2 compress, and approximately 1/2-inch in from each long edge, a tack approximately 1/2-inch long shall be sewn at right angles to or parallel to these edges. As an alternate for the diagonal lines of stitching at each corner of the assembled compresses, and for securing the edges of the bandage (either the short or long opposite edges), these edges may be sewn approximately 3/4-inch in, stitching running the entire length of whichever opposite edges are chosen for sewing. This stitching shall include the gauze facing, the compress contents, that is, absorbent filler, absorbent cellulose, and water-repellent cellulose, or polyethylene, and the nonwoven fabric backing. If this alternate type of end stitching is used, the gauze ends shall be wrapped around the compress contents at the compress ends, prior to stitching, and shall be in apposition to the ends of the nonwoven fabric backing which shall be folded-in to eliminate raw edges. In addition, alternates to the methods of securing the edges of the gauze facing to the nonwoven fabric backing, and of securing the contents of the compress against shifting, as specified above, shall be approved by the procuring activity, prior to use by the contractor or manufacturer. Overlock stitching in the assembly of the compress is not acceptable.

3.3.1.1 Dimensions and weights.

3.3.1.1.1 Size 1. The size 1 finished compress shall measure 18 by 22 inches, plus or minus 1 inch in each direction. These finished compress dimensions shall be determined as specified in 4.4.1. The components of the finished compress, other than the gauze and nonwoven fabric backing, shall have the following weights:

Absorbent filler . . . . . 6 ounces plus or minus 15 percent.

Absorbent cellulose. . . . . 3 ounces plus or minus 15 percent.

Water-repellent cellulose. . . . . 0.36 ounce (minimum).

Polyethylene . . . . . 0.10 ounces (minimum).

Complete compress shall have a minimum weight of 8.9 ounces.

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3.3.1.1.2 Size 2. The size 2 finished compress shall measure 22 by 36 inches, plus or minus 1 inch in each direction. The finished compress dimensions shall be determined as specified in 4.4.1. The components of the finished compress, other than the gauze and nonwoven fabric, shall have the following weights:

Absorbent filler	12 ounces plus or minus 15 percent.
Absorbent cellulose	6 ounces plus or minus 15 percent.
Water-repellent cellulose	0.68 ounce (minimum).
Polyethylene	0.2 ounces (minimum).

Completed compress shall have a minimum weight of 17.8 ounces.

3.3.2 Bandage. The bandages accompanying each compress shall measure 6 inches in width, plus or minus 1/2-inch, and not less than 6 yards in unstretched length when tested as specified in 4.4.6. Bandage shall be fabricated of type VII gauze; the gauze being shrunk (during manufacture of the bandage) in both the warp and filling by passing it through a sodium hydroxide solution bath. This treatment of the gauze shall result in a bandage having an excess crimp in both the warp and filling directions. Thread count of the finished, sterilized bandage, shall be 34 by 20, plus 8, minus 3 threads in each direction. Structure of the finished, sterilized bandage, shall be such that one layer of the bandage shall be capable of clinging to an under layer. No adhesive or sizing materials shall be used in the bandage manufacture. Excess of raveling and loose threads on the edges of the bandages shall be prevented by cutting the edges with pinking knives having teeth of 45° pitch, and 9 plus or minus 1 peaks per inch, by "crushed" edges, or other suitable means. Bandage shall be one continuous piece and shall not be cut on the bias. The pH of the bandage shall be not less than 4.5 nor more than 9.5, when tested as specified in 4.4.9.

3.3.2.1 Elasticity. The ultimate elongation of the finished, sterilized bandage, when tested as specified in 4.4.6.4 shall be 50 percent minimum in both the warp and filling directions. Breaking strength of the finished, sterilized bandage, shall be not less than 15 pounds in the warp and 6 pounds in the filling when tested as specified in 4.4.6.4. The finished, sterilized bandage shall be capable of returning to not more than 23-1/2 inches within 15 minutes after being submitted to the elasticity test as specified in 4.4.6.3.

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3.4 Color. Except as specified in 3.1.4, compress shall be white, excluding backing. The nonwoven fabric backing material and the bandage shall be brown, dyed by use of Pontamine B.T. Brown Concentrate in the amount of 2 ounces of dye per 100 pounds of material, or by use of an acceptable equivalent which shall be approved prior to use by the procuring activity.

3.5 Warning stamp. The following legend: "Put Other Side Next to Wound" shall be legibly and permanently imprinted in heavy-faced type, 1/2 to 1 inch letters, on the nonwoven fabric backing at the approximate center of the finished compress. The ink shall be nonbleeding.

3.6 Moisture content. The finished, delivered compress and bandages shall be dry to the extent that they shall show not more than 1 percent loss in weight when tested as specified in 4.4.7. Compresses or bandages losing more than 1 percent in weight shall be considered as not complying with requirements of this specification.

3.7 Sterility. The compress and bandages shall be sterile when tested with a biological indicator as specified in 4.4.8.

3.7.1 Certificate of sterility. A certificate of sterility, stating that samples from each sterilizer lot have been tested and found to be sterile, shall be submitted to the procuring activity. The certificate of sterility shall include:

a. Item identification.
b. National stock number.
c. Contract or purchase order number.
d. Sterility lot or control number.
e. Date of sterilization.
f. Quantity of product in sterilizer lot.
g. Type of sterilization (gas, radiation, heat, steam, etc.).
h. Form of biological indicator (i.e., inoculated paper spore strip or carrier, inoculated product, or inoculated simulated product).
i. Test organism(s) and population density used.
j. Test medium, incubation temperature, incubation time, and dates of tests.
k. Number of test units.
l. Statement that samples comply with sterility tests.
m. Signature of head of laboratory or a designated qualified alternate.

When inspection is made at destination, the certificate of sterility shall be submitted by the contractor to the Directorate of Medical Materiel, ATTN: DPSC -ATQ, Defense Personnel Support Center, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, Pa., 19101, and a copy forwarded with each shipment to the consignee. When inspection is made at source, certificate of sterility shall be furnished to the cognizant Government Quality Assurance Representative for submission to the procuring activity.

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3.7.2 Sterility lot. A sterility lot is that single quantity of product subjected to the same manufacturing operation and simultaneously sterilized in the same sterilizer chamber. Each unit package shall be clearly marked with a sterility lot (control) number and date of sterilization as specified in 5.3.1. Each sterility lot shall be traceable to the pertinent manufacturing lot(s).

3.8 Workmanship. Workmanship shall be first class throughout. Compresses, bandages, and safety pins shall be free from defects which detract from their appearance or may impair their serviceability.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government'request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of 3 years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

4.1.2 Inspection. Inspection, as used in this specification, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

4.1.3 Certificates of quality. Certificates of quality, supplied by the manufacturer of the component or material, may be furnished in lieu of actual performance of such testing by the contractor, provided lot identity has been maintained and can be demonstrated to the Government. The certificate shall include the name of the contractor, the contract number, the name of the manufacturer or supplier, the NSN, the item identification, the name of the component/material, the lot number, the lot size, the sample size, the date of testing, the test method, individual test results, and the specification requirements.

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4.2 Sampling. Sampling shall be conducted in accordance with Standard MIL-STD-105 and appendix thereto.

	Inspection level	AQL percent defective
For destructive visual examination of components		
Major A.	S-1	2.5
Total (Major A and Minor A).	S-1	6.5
Major B.	S-1	2.5
Total (Major B and Minor B).	S-1	6.5
Major C.	S-4	2.5
Total (Major C and Minor C).	S-4	6.5
For end item examination		
Major D.	S-2	2.5
For sterility test.	S-1 (per sterilization charge)	*

*Acceptance number shall be zero (0) for all sample sizes.

4.2.1 Where possible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more tests.

4.3 Inspection. The general purposes compress and bandage shall be inspected to determine compliance with all requirements contained in sections 3 and 5 of this specification. Nonconformance with these requirements will be permitted to the extent indicated in 4.2.

4.3.1 Examination for preparation for delivery. An examination shall be made to determine whether the packaging, packing, and marking comply with the requirements of Section 5. Defects shall be scored as specified in Table I. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The sample unit shall be one container fully prepared for delivery. The lot shall be the number of containers offered for inspection at one time. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the acceptable quality level shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units.

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Table I. Examination for Preparation for Delivery

Examination	Defect
Containers	Not as specified.
Quantity	Quantity in interior packages and shipping containers not as specified.
Packaging & Packing Materials	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as incomplete closure of container flaps, tape improperly applied, or containers distorted.
Markings	Omitted, incorrect, illegible, improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.

4.3.2 Classification of defects. Inspection shall be conducted in accordance with the following classification of defects:

Categories and defects**	
Major A - Compress	
101	Legend legible and permanent.
102	Security stitching of all compress components not as specified.
103	Compress not assembled properly.
104	Gauze and backing not stitched all around.
Major B - Bandage	
121	Bandage edging not properly prepared to prevent raveling.
122	Bandage not one continuous piece.
Major C - Pin	
141	Pin not uniformly plated.
142	Free end of pin does not gradually taper to a point.

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Categories and defects** (cont'd)	
Major D - Complete sterile package	
161	Unit not complete with all specified component parts.
162	Packaging not as specified.
163	Component parts not clean.
164	Markings not as specified.
Minor - Compress	
201	Compress not free of raw edges.
202	Compress dimensions not as specified.
203	Complete compress not minimum weight.
204	Compress components not as specified.
205	Compress components not colors specified.
206	Thread stitching ends or tails more than 1/4 inch.
Minor B - Bandage	
220	Bandage dimensions not as specified.
221	Bandage not free of excess raveling.
222	Bandage layers do not cling to each other.
223	Color not as specified.
Minor C - Pin	
241	Safety pins not size specified.

**Inspection is not restricted to the classified possible defects listed above.

4.3.3 Dimensional examination. The general purpose compress and bandage shall be inspected for defects in dimensions. Any dimension not within the tolerance specified herein shall be classified as a defect.

4.4 Tests.

4.4.1 Compress dimensions. The finished compress shall be manually stretched to remove folds and wrinkles. The smoothed compress shall be laid flat on a horizontal surface, and without tension applied to the compress, the length and width of the compress shall be measured along its centerlines.

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4.4.2 Absorbent filler. Test procedures for testing compliance of absorbent filler for physical characteristics as specified in 3.1.2 shall be in conformance with Specification L-C-166, except for absorbency and presence of dyes. In all cases where test specimens are to be weighed out prior to test, the specimen shall not be plucked from the filler, but shall be so taken that the specimen includes the complete thickness of the filler.

4.4.2.1 Absorbency. The test specimens for determining the absorbency of the absorbent filler shall weigh 5 grams and shall be taken from the filler in such fashion as to include the total thickness of the filler. The 5-gram specimen shall be pulled apart into five equal pieces and placed in a basket made from copper wire approximately 0.4 millimeter in diameter (No. 26 B. & S.) in the form of a cylinder approximately 5 centimeters in diameter and 8 centimeters deep, with spaces between the wires of approximately 2 centimeters, the basket weighing not more than 3 grams. The basket containing the filler test specimen shall be held on its side approximately 12 millimeters above the surface of the water which is at a temperature of 25° Centigrade, plus or minus 1° Centigrade. The basket shall be allowed to drop to the water and the time in seconds required for complete submersion, the basket shall be removed from the water and allowed to drain for 10 seconds in the same horizontal position, then placed immediately in a tared beaker, covered with a tared watchglass, and weighed. Deducting the weight of the test basket and the filler specimen, the weight of the water absorbed shall be computed.

4.4.2.2 Test for presence of dyes in filler. Approximately 10 grams shall be taken from the filler in such manner as to include the total thickness of the filler, and shall be placed in a narrow percolator, and then extracted slowly with alcohol until percolate measures 50 cubic centimeters. When observed downward through a column 20 centimeters in depth, the percolate may show a yellowish color, but shall not show a blue or a green tint.

4.4.3 Absorbent cellulose. The absorbent cellulose shall be tested for absorbency by use of the same test procedures as specified in 4.4.2.1 for the absorbent filler, except that the test specimen shall consist of 5 grams of absorbent cellulose torn into five equal pieces.

4.4.4 Water-repellent cellulose. A specimen from the 1-ply of the water-repellent cellulose shall be supported horizontally in air by being laid across a ring on a ring stand. A drop of water from a medicine dropper shall be applied, without touching the tissue, from a distance of not more than 1/2-inch. Five minutes after the drop has touched the tissue, the drop shall not have been completely absorbed by the tissue, and the spreading of the drop shall not exceed 3/8-inch in the largest dimension.

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4.4.5 Nonwoven fabric.

4.4.5.1 Water-repellency. Nonwoven fabric backing shall be tested for water-repellency in conformance with method 5526 of Standard 191.

4.4.5.2 Nonwoven fabric, breaking strength and ultimate elongation. The breaking strength and ultimate elongation shall be determined in conformance with method 5100 of Standard 191.

4.4.6 Bandage.

4.4.6.1 Length. Bandages shall be laid out on a horizontal surface and, without any tension being applied to the bandage, the length shall be measured parallel to the edge.

4.4.6.2 Width. Bandage width shall be determined in conformance with method 5020 of FED-TEST-METHOD STD. NO. 191.

4.4.6.3 Bandage elasticity. A full-width bandage, not previously stretched, shall be laid flat on a horizontal surface without tension. A 20-inch portion of the bandage shall be marked off and stretched to 26 inches, being held in this position for a period of 1/2 hour after reaching this elongation. At the end of this period, the bandage shall be released by cutting the bandage at approximately 6 inches beyond the original 20 inch mark-off points (the bandage test strip being prevented from snapping back). The resultant cut strip of bandage shall be allowed to rest for 15 minutes, and the length between the mark-off points again determined without any tension being applied to the strip.

4.4.6.4 Bandage ultimate elongation and breaking strength. Bandage ultimate elongation and breaking strength shall be determined in conformance with method 5100 of FED-TEST METHOD STD. NO. 191. In placing a test sample in the testing machine, the sample shall first be secured in the upper jaws, the sample being secured in the lower jaws after excess wrinkles (but not the inherent crimps) in the bandage have been removed.

4.4.7 Moisture content. All wrappings and the safety pins shall be removed from unbroken unit packages under atmospheric conditions of 65 percent, plus or minus 2 percent, relative humidity at 70° Fahrenheit, plus or minus 2° Fahrenheit. The weights of the compress and two bandages shall be determined under these atmospheric conditions immediately after the wrappings and safety pins have been removed. The compress and bandages shall remain in this atmospheric condition for at least 4 hours, their weights then determined, and the differences, if any, between the original weights and the weights after 4 hours conditioning, computed.

NOTE: This test is not to be performed on compresses and bandages of which the wrappings have been torn, package seal broekn, or wrappings damaged in any way prior to start of test.

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4.4.8 Sterility test. The compress and bandage shall be tested for sterility in accordance with the method specified in the USP for purified cotton, cotton gauze, surgical dressings and related material using inoculated product, inoculated simulated product, or paper spore strip (carrier). The biological indicator (spore strip) shall be contained in the product, not placed between unit boxes. Product containing a biological indicator shall be marked or labeled so that it clearly differentiates from product intended for distribution. The incubation medium and minimum time in each case shall be soybean casein digest for 7 days for inoculated product, inoculated simulated product, or paper spore strip (carrier). The incubation temperature shall be as indicated in paragraph 4.4.8.1. The minimum number of test units, regardless of lot size, shall be 10, except for inoculated carrier which shall be 20 for Type I Sterilization and 30 for Type II Sterilization including inoculated carrier and product test units.

4.4.8.1 Inoculated product or simulated product For each type of sterilization, the organism used shall be as listed below:

Type of Sterilization	Organism	Incubation Temperature
Steam	B. stearothermophilus	55° - 65°C
Dry Heat	B. stearothermophilus, or	55° - 65°C
	B. subtilis var. niger (or globigii)	30° - 35°C
Gas	B. subtilis var. niger (or globigii)	30° - 35°C
Radiation	B. pumilus	30° - 35°C

The number of viable cells shall be sufficient to provide assurance that the product has been sterilized.

4.4.8.2 Inoculated carrier. Inoculated carriers (paper spore strips) if used shall be in accordance with MIL-S-36586. Other paper carriers shall be inoculated to be of equivalent resistance. The method of incubation and number of test units shall be as indicated in 4.4.8 Sterility test and 4.4.8.1 Inoculated product or simulated product. The method of sterilization will control the organism in the spore strip to be tested for as shown in 4.4.8.1. NOTE: When an inoculated carrier is chosen, product samples must also be tested as required by the USP.

4.4.8.3 Alternate method. Suppliers conducting sterility tests or designating lots in a manner other than that indicated herein shall submit proof that the alternate method provides equal assurance concerning the sterility of the product. However, all sterility tests shall be conducted using biological indicators. Requests for approval of any alternate method of testing for sterility shall be made to the Contracting Officer, and approval obtained before employment of the alternate method on a government contract.

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4.4.8.4 Product testing. Testing for sterility of the product after receipt by the government shall be without a biological indicator and in accordance with the U.S.P.

4.4.9 Hydrogen-ion concentration (pH). The pH of bandage shall be tested in conformance with method 2811 of FED-TEST-METHOD STD. NO. 191.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Unit of issue. Each compress and bandage of the size specified, constitutes one unit of issue.

5.1.2 Level A.

5.1.2.1 Unit preparation.

5.1.2.1.1 Roller bandages. Two rolled bandages shall be wrapped or bagged separately or together. The wrap or bag shall be sealed and constructed of suitable material.

5.1.2.1.2 Safety pins. Six safety pins shall be mounted and secured on a card of suitable size and design, or shall be packaged in an envelope; or five pins shall be secured by the sixth pin.

5.1.2.1.3 Assembly. The unit shall be assembled by neatly and tightly folding the white gauze to the inside subsequently folding the two rolled bandages and pins within the dressing and folding so the finished dressing shall measure approximately 5.5 by 18 inches. Each folded dressing shall be wrapped or bagged in a suitable kraft paper. The wrapper or bag shall be sealed and form a snug fit for the unit and shall be capable of maintaining sterility of contents unless damaged or opened.

5.1.2.2 Unit package. Each wrapped or bagged compress and bandage shall be packaged in a heat sealed, opaque, olive drab polyethylene bag fabricated of virgin polyethylene seamless tubing having a minimum wall thickness of 4 mils. One end of the bag shall have a slit with the following or similar legends: "To open tear slit" followed by an arrow pointing toward the slit. Letters shall be in non-smearing black ink, in capitals, 3/32 inches minimum height. The heat seal at either end of the bag shall be at least 1/16 inch in width. On the side opposite the identification legend, the words "Follow Enclosed Instructions" shall be printed in letters ar least 1/8 inch high. Excess air shall be evacuated or expelled from the bag prior to heat sealing.

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5.1.2.3 Intermediate package. Six unit packages containing size 1 compresses and bandage or three unit packages containing size 2 compresses and bandages shall be packaged in a snug fitting box constructed in accordance with PPP-B-636, type CF, class weather-resistant. Closure shall be effected by taping the top and bottom flaps with 2 inch wide tape conforming to MMM-A-250 or metal stitches is permitted.

5.1.3 Level C. Units shall be packaged in standard commercial containers of the size and kind commonly used, which will afford the degree of protection required for shipment and use of the product for its intended purpose.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A. Four intermediate packages containing compresses and bandages of one size only shall be packed in an exterior container designed for a type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. Closure and strapping shall be as specified in the appendix of the box specification.

5.2.2 Level C. The subject commodity shall be packed in substantial commercial containers of the type, size, and kind commonly used for the purpose, so constructed as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common or other carriers, at the lowest rate, to point of delivery called for in the contract or purchase order.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Wrap. The kraft wrap or bag enclosing the assembled unit shall be marked with the following or similar information:

(a) "STERILE"
(b) APPLY WHITE SIDE OF PAD TO WOUND
(c) STERILITY GUARANTEED UNLESS WRAPPER/BAG IS DAMAGED OR OPENED.

5.3.2 Unit package. In addition to the marking as specified in 5.1.2.2, each unit package shall be marked in accordance with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act and MIL-STD-129. In addition, marking shall include the sterility lot or control number, name and address of the manufacturer and the method of sterilization. The method of sterilization (G-Gas, R-Radiation, C-Cold, S-Steam or D-Dry Heat) shall be shown following the level of packaging and date of packaging. Example: "A-1/75-G". Final sterilization shall be on or after indicated packaging date.

5.3.3 Intermediate package. Each intermediate package shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. Sterility lot (control) number, contract or purchase order number shall be shown. The method of sterilization as specified in 5.3.2 shall be shown.

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5.3.4 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. Sterility lot (control) number and the method of sterilization as specified in 5.3.2 shall be shown.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Size and quantity desired (see 1.2).
(c) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).

6.2 Catalog information. This specification is intended to cover the following items appearing in the Federal Supply Catalog:

National Stock No.	Item Identification
6510-00-201-2890	Compress and Bandage, Camouflaged, 18 by 22 inch compress
6510-00-201-2900	Compress and Bandage, Camouflaged, 22 by 36 inch Compress

6.3 Commercial information. This specification does not include all types, classes, styles or sizes of the commodity indicated by the title of this specification, or which are normally procured to meet military requirements.

Custodians:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing activity:
Defense Supply Agency - DM

Project No. 6510-0608
is

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

OMB Approval
No. 22-R255

INSTRUCTIONS: The purpose of this form is to solicit beneficial comments which will help achieve procurement of suitable products at reasonable cost and minimum delay, or will otherwise enhance use of the document. DoD contractors, government activities, or manufacturers/vendors who are prospective suppliers of the product are invited to submit comments to the government. Fold on lines on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements. Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document. If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity.

DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER AND TITLE
MIL-C-16893B

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A
☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?
   A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

   B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY DOCUMENT REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE DOCUMENT RESTRICTIVE?
   ☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "Yes", in what way?)*

4. REMARKS

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and address - Optional)*

TELEPHONE NO.

DATE

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